Argument in Favor of Measure X
Merced Union High School District, School Facilities Improvement District No. 2

Everyone knows the importance and value of quality high schools. High quality schools raise student achievement, boost property values, prepare children for a productive future, and make neighborhoods safer. Our teachers and staff do their best in educating our children, but many classrooms and school facilities at Atwater and Buhach Colony High Schools are old and inadequate to provide students with the facilities they need to succeed.

Our students need your YES vote on Measure X! Atwater High School was built in 1958 and Buhach Colony High School in 2001, and while well maintained, many of their classrooms and buildings no longer meet 21st century standards. Measure X will allow the District to improve the quality of education provided to local students by repairing, renovating, and modernizing outdated classrooms and school facilities. It will also bring equity to every campus.

If passed, Measure X will improve education by providing funding at Atwater and Buhach Colony High Schools including:

- Repairing and replacing leaky roofs
- Renovating Career Technical Education classrooms and labs
- Renovating or constructing gymnasiums, theaters, and band rooms
- Making health and safety improvements
- Repairing or replacing deteriorating plumbing and sewer systems

Measure X makes financial sense and protects taxpayers.

- By law, spending must be reviewed and annually audited by an independent citizens' oversight committee.
- All bond funds must be spent locally and cannot be taken by the State.
- Funds can only be spent on schools, not for administrator or teacher salaries.
- If passed, the District qualifies for State matching funds to help pay for school repairs.

Measure X repairs old and inadequate classrooms and facilities, improves the education of local students, and maintains the quality of our community. It is a needed investment in our children and their schools and something we can all support. Please join us and VOTE YES ON MEASURE X!

/s/ Kurt E. Kollman, Retired Educator
/s/ Gary D. Parreira, Retired Educator
/s/ Ralph Calderon, Retired Educator